assets from external real-world sources. Moreover, data may have to be obtained at the time of execution and may not be available at the time of deployment of the contract. Let's look at some examples:

- *Temperatures on Mount Kilimanjaro on a given day* -- The temperatures are universal facts, but they have to be obtained from an authentic external weather source.
- *Stock market data* --This data may be the high and low prices of a stock on a particular date on the NASDAQ market. This condition ensures that all the participants on the chain get the same consistent outcome for a smart contract operation.

How do you get access to external resources? Accessing data sources external to the smart contract is addressed by a concept called *oracles*. An oracle service fetches external data for a smart contract. Merriam-Webster defines oracle as "an authoritative or wise expression or answer." This definition closely defines the role of the oracle service in smart-contract development.

> **DEFINITION** An oracle service is a data carrier between web resources (APIs and URLs) and a smart contract. An oracle service is located outside the blockchain protocol.

An oracle is a useful component that facilitates the availability of real-world facts needed for the functioning of certain smart contracts. Provable (https://provable .xyz/index.html) is an implementation of an oracle service for getting outside data into a smart contract. Chainlink (https://chain.link/features) is a more recent oracle service for smart contracts to access external data feeds, APIs, and payments.